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Innovative AspenTech Solution Delivers New Levels of Manufacturing Performance to Polymers Industry

23-Oct-2002

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Aspen Technology, Inc. announced a breakthrough in advanced process control technology that enables polymer manufacturers to achieve significant improvements in manufacturing performance. The unique, patented technology has already been successfully implemented at the polyethylene plant operated by SABIC Polyolefine GmbH in Gelsenkirchen, Germany, delivering faster product transitions, reduced off-specification material and improved product quality.

The new product, Aspen Apollo, uses next-generation artificial intelligence technology to apply advanced control to the highly complex processes found in the polymers industry. This enables manufacturers to gain significant benefits during all phases of plant operations, but particularly during the critical transitions between different product grades. These transitions are typically time-consuming, resulting in lost manufacturing capacity and generating large quantities of waste material.

With its ability to consistently maintain safe and efficient operation during both steady-state and dynamic conditions, the advanced technology used by Aspen Apollo provides a significant step forward from earlier neural-net based solutions. The technology also enables manufacturers to achieve faster time-to-benefit, since the models that form the basis of the controller can be created using historical plant data, avoiding the need for an extended implementation period within the plant to build and validate the model.

Aspen Apollo is an important element of the Aspen Plantelligence solution for the polymers industry. Plantelligence is AspenTech's integrated solution for manufacturing execution, which enables companies to manage their manufacturing operations in real-time, improving their efficiency and

profitability.

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